STEVEN CLARKE

SOFTWARE ENGINEER
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Summary

Staff Software Engineer with 10 years of experience delivering backend APIs, event-driven microservices, and cloud architectures. Led the redesign of a media-supply-chain platform, building ingestion processes that reduced costly manual entry of technical metadata by 80% or more and creating an automated testing framework that cut QA cycle time for application releases in half. Passionate about applying AI-assisted development workflows to build reliable, scalable solutions while mentoring the next generation of engineers.

Skills

AREAS OF EXPERTISE
Software Engineering
Cloud Software Architecture
Amazon Web Services
Agile Methodology
Automated Testing
SQL
REST APIs
Estimation
Infrastructure as Code
AI Assisted Development
CI/CD
Release and Deployment
Backend Development
Relational Database
Document Databases
NoSQL
Test-Driven Development
Infrastructure
Monitoring
Testing Frameworks
Containerization
Distributed Systems
Infrastructure at Scale
Data Structures and Algorithms
Systems Design (LLD)
API Design
Data Modeling

Languages
Typescript
Python
Java
JavaScript
Kotlin
SQL
Go

Tools
AWS
GitLab CI
Terraform
Kafka
Docker
Spring Boot
Express
Git
GitLab
Cursor
Claude
AI
PostgreSQL
Amazon EC2
Amazon DynamoDB
Amazon S3
Amazon ECS/EKS
GitHub Actions
Linux

Achievements

- **Designed, built and managed multiple production releases of a cloud based media file transfer system to replace a legacy on-premise system for a major film studio:** Objectives were achieved with a small team in a less than one year timeline and enabled our client's department to hit deadlines for sun-setting a legacy data center, resulting in 7 figure savings for the organization. Improved file transfer speeds over the legacy application reducing overhead for the business.
- **Designed and built a prototype automated testing framework for a major film studio:** In an effort to modernize a QA process that relied entirely on end to end manual validation, I developed a system for storing and querying the results of asynchronous micro service executions within a workflow that was eventually adopted by the as the department standard for testing asynchronous event driven applications.
- **Migrated a marketing web application for a major car manufacturer to a new digital asset management backend.:-** The migration was achieved in a less than 3 month time frame without any support from the original application developers. This resulted in 6 figure saving for the organization due to not having to renew the license for the legacy system.
- **Built a web application on top of FASPEX to provide secure file transfer for a major toy manufacturer.:** Delivered a customized application to production with a two person team in a short timeframe.
- **Automated descriptive media metadata gathering to automate downstream digital media supply chain processes for a major film studio.:** Lead a small team to build a web application frontend and backend API services to introspect media files and provide automated metadata to downstream processes. This unlocked the ability to automate previously manual processes related to file transcoding and web streaming delivery resulting in increased efficiency, fewer failures in the workflow, and lower cost.
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Mentored engineers on my team to a high level or proficiency through hands on collaboration, pair programming and radical ownership practices.: Focusing on developer enablement and a team culture of integrity is one of the things I'm proudest of doing in my career.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Qvest.US | *Staff Software Engineer* **Feb 2021 - Jul 2025**

Combination technical lead, software architect, and individual contributor on a diverse range of enterprise technology projects.

- Served as technical lead and software architect for enterprise technology consulting projects, helping media and entertainment clients deliver reliable technology solutions
- Modernized clients' digital media supply chains by designing and implementing scalable web applications, web service APIs, event-driven microservices, and orchestrated workflows that improved the processing and delivery of media content to vendors and major streaming platforms
- Applied Agile team practices, including stand-ups, requirements gathering and refinement, architectural reviews, and retrospectives, improving team alignment and delivery planning
- Invested in pair programming and developer enablement to delegate work across teams, strengthen engineering skills, and support developer growth, resulting in ~50% fewer feedback cycles on PRs and 30% greater sprint velocity across my team compared to metrics from sprints prior to instituting pair programming practices
- Guided client enterprise architecture teams in defining and adopting standardized development processes, deployment models, and automated testing frameworks for enterprise applications, improving consistency and accelerating release cycles across client organizations
- Led workshops and created guidelines on AI-assisted software development, which increased team adoption of AI tools and shortened feature implementation time.

Senior Software Engineer **Aug 2017 - Feb 2021**

Individual contributor with a focus on backend APIs and service integrations, while taking on increasing technical leadership responsibilities.

- Consistently met or exceeded sprint goals as an individual contributor on enterprise technology consulting projects, focusing on backend APIs and service integrations while taking on technical lead responsibilities and helping deliver software projects
- Served as lead code reviewer across multiple professional services vendors in a large-scale application development effort, ensuring alignment and quality of deliverables, identifying and correcting numerous code defects during development, and reducing costly QA cycles
- Developed internal accelerators, proofs of concept, and application templates for Qvest.US, improving the sales and delivery of software development projects
- Trained team members on data model design, project bootstrapping, automated testing, validation, and version control, resulting in fewer defects during QA and stronger adherence to standard engineering practices

Qvest.US (formerly OnPrem Solutions Partners) | *Software Engineer* **Sep 2016 - Aug 2017**

Mid level individual contributor with focus on backend APIs and service integrations.

- Developed backend API services with Java, Spring, and AWS for a digital-asset-management system used by a major toy manufacturer, delivering reliable data handling that supported critical business operations
- Nominated for and awarded Employee of the Quarter for high-quality contributions to the project team under pressure within a short time frame
- Participated in Agile sprints, refined requirements in JIRA, implemented features using Test-Driven Development, and performed code reviews, resulting in higher code quality and faster release cycles

Red Hat Consulting | *Associate Software Engineer* **Feb 2012 - Nov 2015**

Entry level engineer working in Red Hat's professional services organization with a focus on enterprise middleware products.

- Developed Java/Spring applications using Red Hat JBoss middleware for public- and private-sector clients
- Traveled on-site to client organizations, collaborating with development teams to implement Agile and CI/CD processes using Jenkins and Red Hat JBoss

Hoover's / Dunn & Bradstreet | *Software Engineering Intern* **Jun 2011 - Dec 2011**

Recent college graduate with SQL and Python scripting capabilities

- Built automation using Python to source data for an in-house reporting solution, enabling the team to generate reports automatically and eliminate manual data-gathering effort
- Migrated data processing from spreadsheet-based workflows to a SQL database using Python scripts, which streamlined data delivery to the application and reduced manual errors
- Produced product documentation and transitioned ownership of automation to future owners of the application.

EDUCATION

University of Texas, Austin | *Bachelors Degree in Computer Science* **May 2007 - Apr 2011**

Certifications

- AWS Certified Developer Associate, Amazon Web Services